> numbers that may be of vital use to the investigation. The first telephone number is against two names—Nalini and Das. The second telephone number belongs to a provision store in Porur, Madras, as per inquiry. Further investigation by the ‘Q’ Branch of Tamil Nadu Police and inquiries made into the said person, Miss Nalini, revealed that she was working with M/s Anabond Silicon Pvt Ltd in Adyar, Madras. However, the ‘Q’ Branch could not proceed further in the absence of any other incriminating evidence.[2]

Koneswaran was handed over to the CBI. During interrogation, he told the SIT that he was one of the nine-member assassination squad that had reached Kodiakkarai on the Tamil Nadu coast from Jaffna on 1 May 1991 under the command of Sivarasan. It was the first time an LTTE cadre was confessing to the presence of a ‘hit squad’ in Tamil Nadu—or India, for that matter. The ‘Q Branch’ of the Tamil Nadu police swung into action. Koneswaran further confessed that the LTTE supremo Prabhakaran had sent him to India to kill Sri Lankan leader Varadaraja Perumal, who was exiled in the country. Indian intelligence agencies had kept Perumal in a safe house in Bhopal after the assassination of EPRLF leader Padmanabha in Madras in 1990. The SIT came to know of Koneswaran’s detention and flew him to Madras in a helicopter.

Koneswaran turned out to be a good catch. He further told the SIT that he had moved to Madras and stayed at the Esware Lodge. There he had met a fellow LTTE cadre, Murugan, who gave him a chit containing his name as ‘Das’ and another name, ‘Nalini’, along with her contact number, 419493. The investigators were hearing Murugan’s name for the second time.

Ragothaman, the IO of the case, placed the photographs taken by Haribabu in front of Koneswaran and asked him to identify the woman in the orange-and-green salwar kameez and the man in the white kurta pyjama. After trying to dodge his questions in vain, Koneswaran identified the man in the photograph as Sivarasan, alias Raghuvaran, and disclosed that he was a trusted soldier of Prabhakaran. This came as a breakthrough.